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Budget Smartphones



Honor 4X

crib about lack of sharpness in the display. The touch response on the Honor 4X is smooth too, making it fairly easy to use.

The size of the device, however, does not facilitate convenience in using it. Additionally, it is among one of the heaviest of the lot. Looking at slimmer, lighter alternatives in the segment which provide equal or better overall performance, the Honor 4X makes considerably lesser sense, even with a good camera quality and best-in-class battery stamina.

HTC DESIRE 526G+

The HTC Desire 526G+, despite being the smallest of the lot, fails to hold its compactness as leverage for competing with the rest. On paper, it runs on a MediaTek MT6592 1.7GHz octa-core processor, with 1GB of RAM, 8GB internal storage, a 4.7-inch 540x960px IPS display, and a 2200mAh battery pack.

The low-display resolution appears downright dull (this

is the only device that has a sub-HD display), and it doesn't come out as a device ideal for gaming, owing majorly to the rather disappointing visuals when compared to the other devices here. Browsing and other lighter tasks do not face any significant stutters, but the device begins showing signs of stress when multiple applications are being run simultaneously. The battery test returned battery life of a little more than 7 hours, and real life usage barely made it last up to one day. One major hindrance here is that it is downright difficult to view content on the screen in broad daylight, owing to the lack of brightness and a reflective screen.

The HTC Desire 526G+

also happens to be the only phone within this shootout that does not have 4G capabilities. With its numerous limitations, it makes almost no sense to bank on an established brand based only on ergonomics and just decent overall performance.

BEST BUY: Yu Yureka Plus

While the Yu Yureka Plus does have its limitations, it is still the cheapest offering in the segment, and offers comparable performance output when compared to the other, best-performing devices in this segment. It handles regular usage with ease, runs most of the games well until a certain point of time, and is an overall good device, that just about beats the Meizu M2 Note in terms of value for money. While the Asus Zenfone 2 Laser is also a considerable proposition, looking at its laser-assisted

autofocus feature, the Yu Yureka Plus makes for a better overall device that takes decent photographs, albeit with a slightly slower focusing mechanism that does not hinder usage too much.

At ₹8,999, the Yu Yureka Plus is the best value for money within the segment of smartphones priced under ₹13,000.

BEST PERFORMER: Meizu M2 Note

The Meizu M2 Note had a reasonably clear upper hand here, after narrowly missing out on being the device with the best value for money. To enhance the first impression of a buyer, the Meizu M2 Note comes with a minimum number of essential apps installed, thereby completely removing the concept of bloatware from the device. Multitasking, prolonged gaming and extensive messaging and browsing were flawless, and that, coupled with the strong battery life, makes the Meizu M2

Note a device that is even worth competing against smartphones of a higher price bracket.

It also happens to feature the best display in its class, overshadowing the Lenovo K3 Note that set a number of synthetic benchmark scores, but fell behind in real life. And, although audio quality is not the best, it is decent to provide you with satisfactory audio quality through your favourite pair of headphones, and honestly, how much do we listen to music on a smartphone's in-built speaker, anyway? Priced at ₹9,999, it is our Best Performer of the lot.

EDITOR'S PICK: Xiaomi Mi 4i

The Xiaomi Mi 4i comes mighty close in matching the Meizu M2 Note's performance prowess, but loses out on account of its heavier UI load, and Meizu's uninterrupted speed and ease of usage. However, the Mi 4i is undeniably convenient to use, and features an equally good display. Additionally, Xiaomi's MiUI is a more advanced custom ROM over Meizu's Flyme OS at the moment, giving a number of customisability options to the user. This, coupled with the aspect of Xiaomi's wider presence in terms of service and consumer fulfilment, along with a wider availability of accessories, make the Mi 4i justify its price.

The Xiaomi Mi 4i is a suave, compact device that is ergonomic - lightweight, with a crisp, 5-inch Full HD screen that is crisp enough to view content, and just about the right size. It is this balance between power and petite, that sees the Xiaomi Mi 4i, priced at ₹12,999, take away our Editor's Pick for the sub-13k smartphone segment.



HTC Desire 526G+